PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	Effects of implementing Pressure Ulcer Prevention Practice Guidelines (PUPPG) in the prevention of pressure ulcers among hospitalized elderly patients: A systematic review protocol
AUTHORS	Wung Buh, Amos; Mahmoud, Hassan; Chen, Wenjun; McInnes, Matthew D. F.; Fergusson, Dean

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Giovanni Cicceri University of Messina, Italy
REVIEW RETURNED	18-Aug-2020

GENERAL COMMENTS	This paper presents a survey about pressure ulcers (PU), a serious problem that is possible to have in all medical specialities and in all age, especially in elderly people. This study aims to review all studies that implement all PU prevention strategies recommended in PU Guidelines. The goal is clear of what the study found, and the works are referenced correctly. In the background section, it is clear what is known about this topic. The study methods are valid and reliable. Despite data were presented in an appropriate manner, it would be better for the authors to improve quality of the paper to specify whether the study is based on a random or pseudo-sample and to clarify whether the criteria for inclusion in the sample are defined.

REVIEWER	Young Sook Roh Chung-Ang University, Republic of Korea
REVIEW RETURNED	20-Aug-2020

GENERAL COMMENTS	Thank you for the opportunity to review this manuscript. The researchers systematically described the overall review process. One thing I want to mention is that the authors need to add the PRISMA framework. I am looking forward to the final results of this study applying the protocol.

REVIEWER	Werku Etafa Wollega University, Ethiopia
REVIEW RETURNED	25-Dec-2020

GENERAL COMMENTS	Dear Editor, this area of study needs high consideration due to the increasing of pressure ulcer globally. The PUPG is also lack in developing countries and still there is little attention to PI prevention.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer: 1

This paper presents a survey about pressure ulcers (PU), a serious problem that is possible to have in all medical specialities and in all age, especially in elderly people. This study aims to review all studies that implement all PU prevention strategies recommended in PU Guidelines. The goal is clear of what the study found, and the works are referenced correctly. In the background section, it is clear what is known about this topic. The study methods are valid and reliable. Despite data were presented in an appropriate manner, it would be better for the authors to improve quality of the paper to specify whether the study is based on a random or pseudo-sample and to clarify whether the criteria for inclusion in the sample are defined.

Response: Thank you for appreciating our paper and your recommendation. The study does not have a predefined sample of papers to review but all studies that have assessed the effect of pressure ulcers preventive strategies found in the PUPPG, on vitally stable bed ridden hospitalized patients aged 60 and above shall be included in the study. We have mentioned this in the text under “interventions” in the “inclusion criteria”.

Reviewer: 2

Thank you for the opportunity to review this manuscript.
The researchers systematically described the overall review process. One thing I want to mention is that the authors need to add the PRISMA framework. I am looking forward to the final results of this study applying the protocol.

Response: Thank you for this keen observation. As requested by reviewer, we have added the PRISMA framework as an appendix and referenced it in the text.

Reviewer: 3

Dear Editor, this area of study needs high consideration due to the increasing of pressure ulcer globally. The PUPG is also lack in developing countries and still there is little attention to PI prevention.

Response: Thank you for appreciating our work.